

Title: Living in a Bubble: Social Media's Link to Fixed Opinions

By: Group 4 Section 16 (Psy101 Course)

Brac University

13th December 2025

Introduction:

Nowadays social media has become a major source for news. Newsfeed of these media are generally based on the person's interests and beliefs. Social media is changing how people are getting news and their way of participation in public conversation (Georgetown University, 2023). When a person get news titled with his type of belief his opinion on that matter gets stronger, making all the other possibilities and opinions worthless. However, most research focuses on the reliance on only social media for news. This study aims to find how news from social media influences its consumers.

Research Hypothesis:

Hypothesis: People who get most of their news from social media are more likely to say they are 100% sure their opinion is the right one.

Significance of the study:

This research will clear the understanding of how social media is influencing its consumer that their opinions are the only one that are right rest are vague.

Methodology:

This study will use a Quantitative Research design. Specifically, it is a correlational study aimed at identifying the strength and direction of the linear relationship between the two variables.

a) Participants:

30 to 50 Brac University student aged 20-25 (aiming for an even male/female split, if possible)

b) Instruments:

The data will be collected using a single, self-administered online survey via Google Forms. The survey contains three distinct scales, all utilizing a 7-point Likert scale (1 = Strongly Disagree to 7 = Strongly Agree)

c) Procedure:

The participants who are interested in a survey will be given the link of the google form and would be asked to complete all the questions.

The google form will have 3 sets of questions tackling each part of the research.

The first set would ask the individual how much of the news they consume are through social media sites.

The second set would present the individual with a current hot topic and ask their opinions to see if they have a strong opinion about it or not. Consequently, the topic will be chosen in such a way that it has a secondary side to the story.

The final set would ask the user if they actively have avoided posts which oppose their views blocking any third party opinions.

d) Analysis:

The collected data will be analyzed using Pearson's Correlation Coefficient and linear regression to test the hypothesized relationships between the scale scores.

Ethical Consideration:

Participant consent will be obtained. Data will be anonymized and confidential. Participant will have the right to withdraw anytime. Ethical approved will be taken.

Reference:

Georgetown University. (2023). *Global health trends*.
<https://share.google/raZ5MUGzgNAjcv4eU>